سبيل

SABEEL

INSTITUTE

Kanban

User Manual

App version 0.15.1 · November 2026

Welcome! This guide covers everything you can do in Sabeel Kanban — from finding your first board to running boards and approving accounts. It is organized by what you do: **everyone** starts with Part 1; if you **run a board**, add Part 2; **admins** add Part 3. Part 4 is a quick "How do I…?" index you can skim any time.

The app works the same on the website (https://sabeel-institute-kanban.web.app) and the Android app — same account, same data, live everywhere. It is **phone-first**: the mobile layout is its own thing, not a squeezed desktop board. Throughout this guide, where the phone and browser layouts differ, you'll see both: the phone first, then the browser.

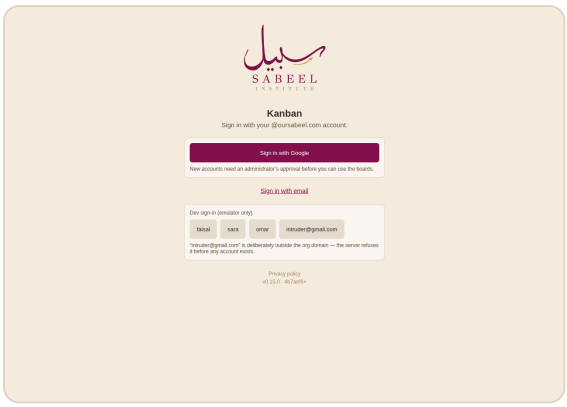
The big picture (2 minutes)

1. **Work lives on boards.** A board is a set of **columns** (like *To Do → In Progress → Done*) holding **cards**. Each card is one piece of work.
2. **You see the boards you've been added to** — nobody else's, unless you are an admin. Each board has one or more **owners** who run it: they add people, shape the columns, and decide who else owns it.
3. **A card carries everything about a task** — a description, a priority, a due date, the people assigned, labels, and a comment thread. Open it to see or change any of that in one place.
4. **Everything is live and shared.** Move a card and everyone watching sees it move. **My Work** gathers every card assigned to you, across every board, so you never have to go board-hunting to find what's yours.

That's the whole system. Everything below is detail.

Part 1 — For everyone

1.1 Signing in



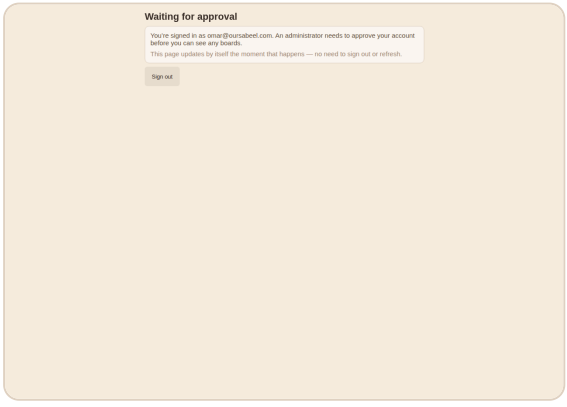
Open the app or website and tap **Sign in with Google**. Sign-in is restricted to your **@oursabeel.com** account — no other account works, and there is no password to remember. **Sign in with email**, under it, is not for your account: always use Google.

On a phone, sign in on the website first

The very first time only. The phone app signs you in; it does not set your account up. So sign in once at the website, and after that the app works normally on the same account.

Install the app before doing that and it will say **“This account isn’t set up for the app yet.”** Nothing is wrong — sign in on the website, then open the app again.

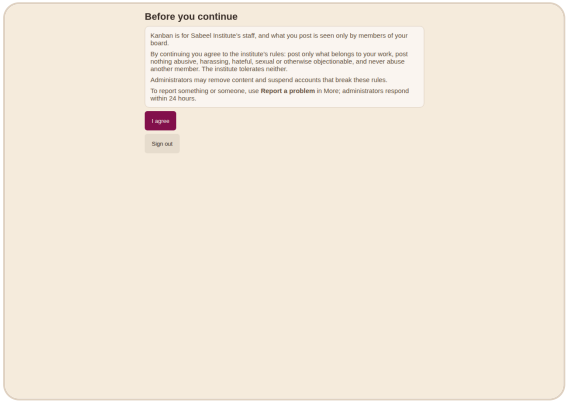
First time? You’ll wait for approval



The very first sign-in sets your account up, which shows **“Setting up your account…”** for a moment. If it takes longer than usual you’ll see **“Still setting up your account”** with **Try again**: nothing is wrong with your account, the server is just slow. Try again in a minute.

New accounts land on a **“Waiting for approval”** screen. An administrator has to approve your account before you can see any boards — this is deliberate, and it takes them one tap. Leave the page open: it lets you in by itself the moment they approve you, with no need to sign out or refresh. If you seem stuck here, contact your admin.

Then, once: the institute’s rules

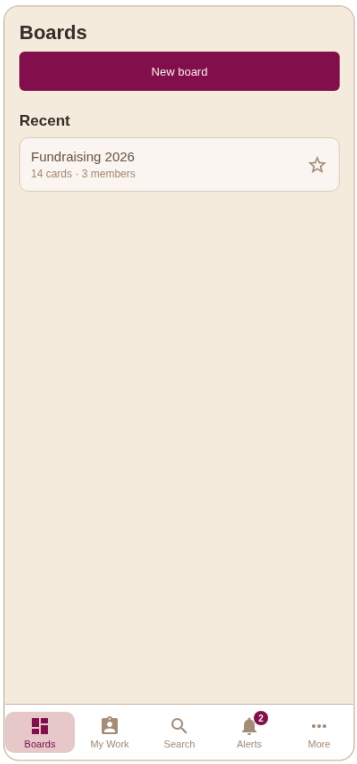


Before your first board you see **“Before you continue”**: Kanban is for the institute’s staff, what you post is seen only by members of your board, and by continuing you agree to the institute’s rules — post only what belongs to your work, post nothing abusive, harassing, hateful, sexual or otherwise objectionable, and never abuse another member. Administrators may remove content and suspend accounts that break them.

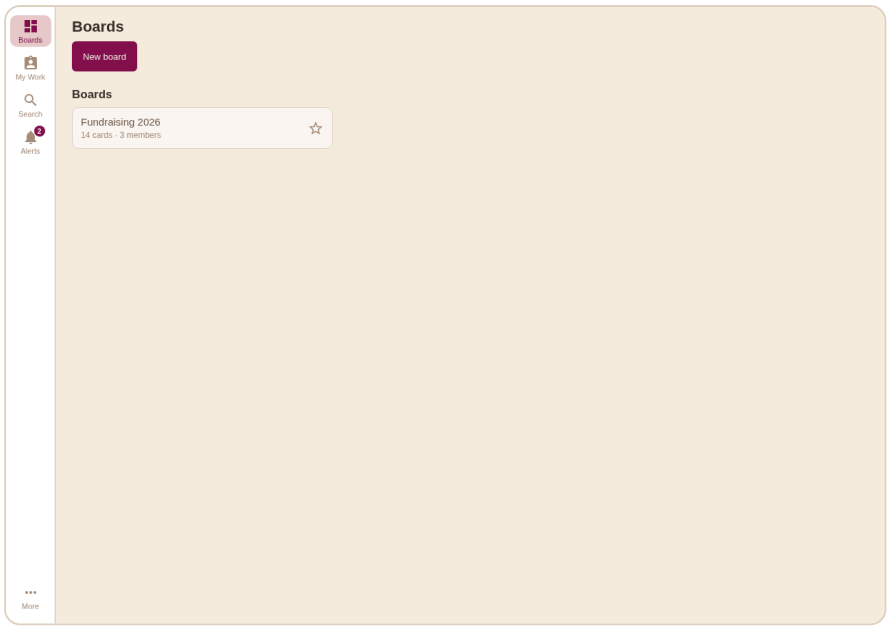
Tap **I agree** to go on, or **Sign out** if you would rather not. You agree once for your account: the screen does not come back on another phone, another browser, or the next time you sign in.

1.2 Finding your way around

A slim navigation bar is always in reach — **along the bottom on a phone**, and **down the left side in a browser**. It carries the places you move between:



On a phone — a bar along the bottom



In a browser — a rail down the left

- **Boards** — your board list, the home screen.
- **My Work** — every card assigned to you, across every board.
- **Search** — find a card by its words.
- **Alerts** — what you've been told about; a badge shows how many are unread, and a screen reader says the number too.
- **More** — everything that isn't a place you go often: **Stats** (admins), **People** (admins), **Help**, **Report a problem**, **Privacy policy** and **Sign out**. It also shows the version of the app you're running, which is the first thing to quote if something looks wrong.

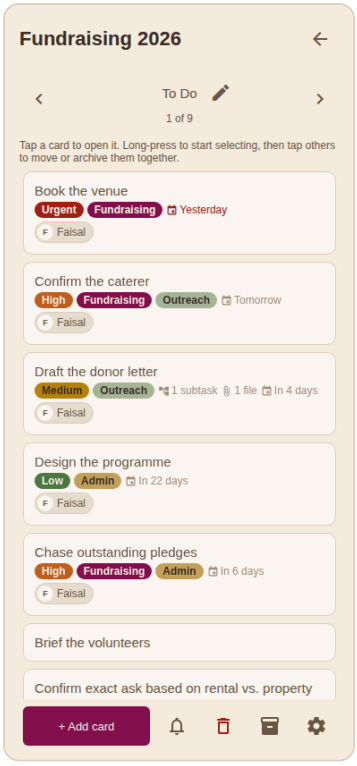
Open a board or a card and the phone's bottom bar steps aside, giving the board the whole screen; it returns when you go back to a list. In a browser the left rail stays put — it's narrow enough to keep out of the way.

1.3 Your boards

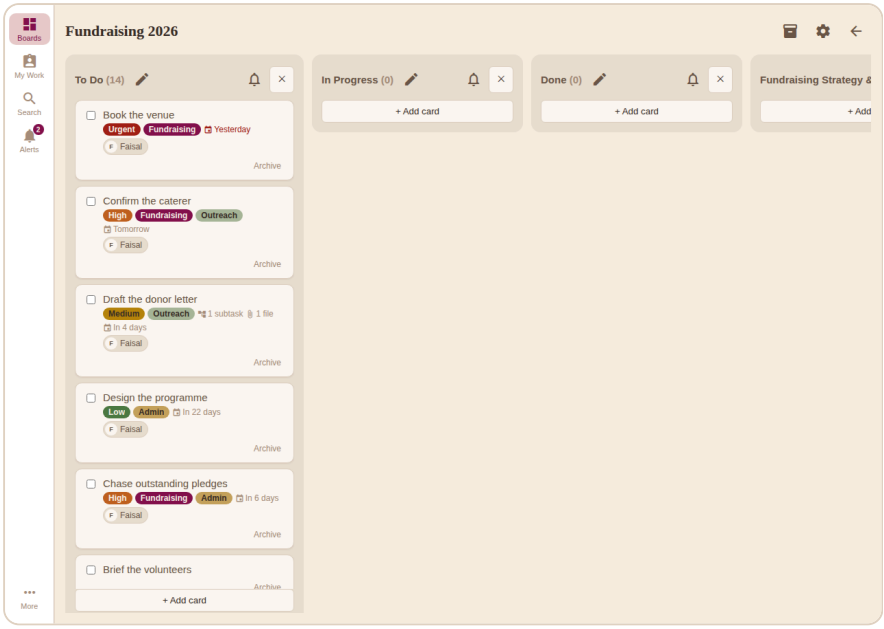
Boards lists everything you can open. Tap the **star** beside a board to keep it at the top; boards you've opened recently follow, then the rest alphabetically.

Every board shows as a card in a grid on wide screens, and as a single-column list on a phone. If your account can create boards, **New board** is at the top (see Part 2).

1.4 Inside a board



On a phone — one column, swipe between



In a browser — every column at once

A board is columns of cards. **In a browser** you see every column at once. **On a phone** one column fills the screen — swipe left and right to move between them, or tap the **arrows** either side of the column name. Under the name it tells you where you are (“2 of 4”).

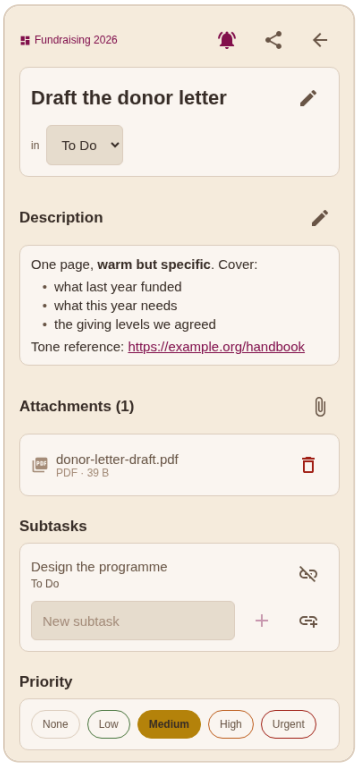
Each card shows, at a glance: its **title**, a **priority badge**, its **labels**, its **due date** (red if overdue), and the **people assigned** (as name chips) — so you can read a card without opening it. A card with no priority set shows no badge. Tap **+ Add card** at the bottom of a column, type a title, press Enter — that’s a new card. The **bell** beside the title is on, so you’re subscribed to the card you make and hear about everything on it (see **Subscribe**, below); tap it before adding if you’d rather not.

Each column has a **bell** too: **watch** a column to be told whenever a card arrives in it — moved in, added to it or restored from the archive. Watching a column doesn’t subscribe you to its cards; open one from the notification and use its own bell if you want to follow it. A card that passes through on its way to another column doesn’t count.

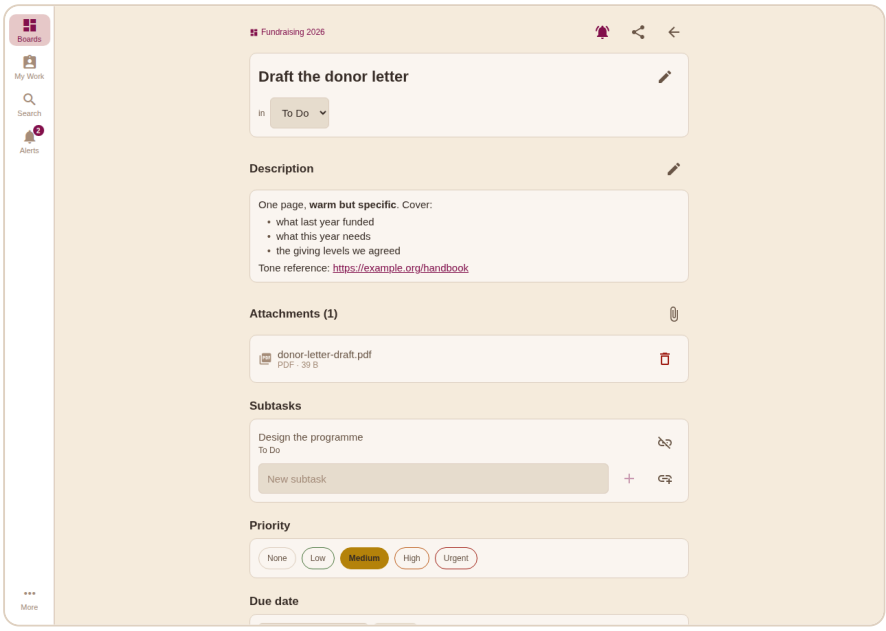
On a phone the row along the bottom holds everything else: beside **+ Add card** are icons to watch the column, delete it (owners of the board only), open the board's **archived cards**, and open the board's **settings** — or, if you do not own it, its **members**, which is the same screen without the controls. They sit there rather than in the header so the board's name has the top row to itself.

1.5 Working with a card

Tap any card to open the full view.



On a phone



In a browser

- **Title** — shown in full as the card's heading, however long it is. Tap the **pencil** to edit it, then **Save**.
- **Column** — a dropdown showing where the card sits. Change it to move the card without leaving it.
- **Description** — formatted text. A small row of buttons above the box gives you **bold**, *italic*, a **bulleted list**, a **numbered list** and a **link**. Select some words and tap a button, or tap it first and start typing. **Save** to keep it, **Cancel** to discard.

Those five are the whole set, on purpose — no headings, colours, tables or fonts. A card is a note about a piece of work, not a document, and the app is deliberately not ClickUp.

Two shortcuts, if you like typing: start a line with `-` for a bullet or `1.` for a number, and it becomes a list as you go.

Web addresses become links by themselves. Paste or type one and it turns into something people can tap — you don't need the link button for that. Use the link button when you want a word to carry the address instead, like the handbook.

The link button asks for two things: the **address** first, then the **text to show**. If you selected some words before tapping it, they are already filled in as the text, and you only need the address. Leave the text empty and the address stands in for it. **Add link** stays greyed out until the address is one the card can actually open — it must start with `http://`, `https://` or `mailto:`.

Pasting from elsewhere is safe and simplified. Copy from a document or a web page and anything the card cannot show — headings, colours, tables, images — arrives as ordinary text with the bold, italics, lists and links kept. Nothing is silently mangled; it is just reduced to what a card holds. - **Attachments** — files on the card. See below. A card with files shows a small **paperclip and count** on the board, so you can see which cards carry something without opening them. - **Subtasks** — see below. - **Priority** — none / low / medium / high / urgent, shown as a coloured **badge** on the card face (e.g. *Urgent*); *none* shows no badge. - **Due date** — a whole day, not a time. Pick it from a calendar; **Clear** removes it. An overdue card shows in red and says *Overdue*. - **Assignees** — anyone on the board. Tap the **add-person** icon beside the *Assignees* heading, then pick a name; the **remove-person** icon on a row unassigns them. They show as **name chips** on the card face, the card lands in each person's **My Work**, and they're notified. - **Labels** — a short vocabulary shared by **every** board, shown as coloured **badges** on the card face. Press **+** to add one to the shared set and this card at once. - **Comments** — discuss the work, with the same five formatting buttons the description has. Type **@** to pull someone in and they're notified; that works anywhere in a sentence, not only at the end. A list of everyone on the board appears above the box — **anyone assigned to the card comes first**, and it scrolls if the board is large. Keep typing to narrow it, or tap a name. On a computer you can stay on the keyboard: ↑/↓ to move, **Enter** or **Tab** to pick, **Esc** to dismiss.

The list closes when you click away, and picking a name never loses your place in the box. - **Subscribe** — the **bell** in the card's header. Tap it to hear about everything on a card even when it isn't assigned to you: new comments, and any change its activity records — moved, renamed, a

new due date, a file attached and so on. Tap again to stop. It turns solid while you're subscribed, and it's already on for cards you made yourself. A card assigned to you already tells you all of this, but subscribing as well means you keep hearing about it if you're later unassigned.

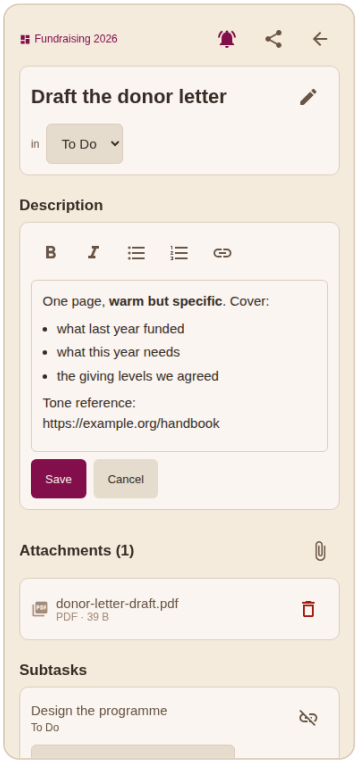
Changes come **together, not one by one**: once someone has finished with a card for two minutes, you get one notification listing what they changed, so a run of edits buzzes your phone once. Comments and mentions arrive straight away. Archiving a card sends one last notification; after that it's quiet until someone restores it.

You can edit your own comment with the **pencil**, and the **@** works there too — mention someone in an edit and they're told, once. Correcting the wording afterwards doesn't notify anyone again. - **Activity** — who changed what, and when, including subtasks being linked and unlinked. Written by the system, so no one can edit it.

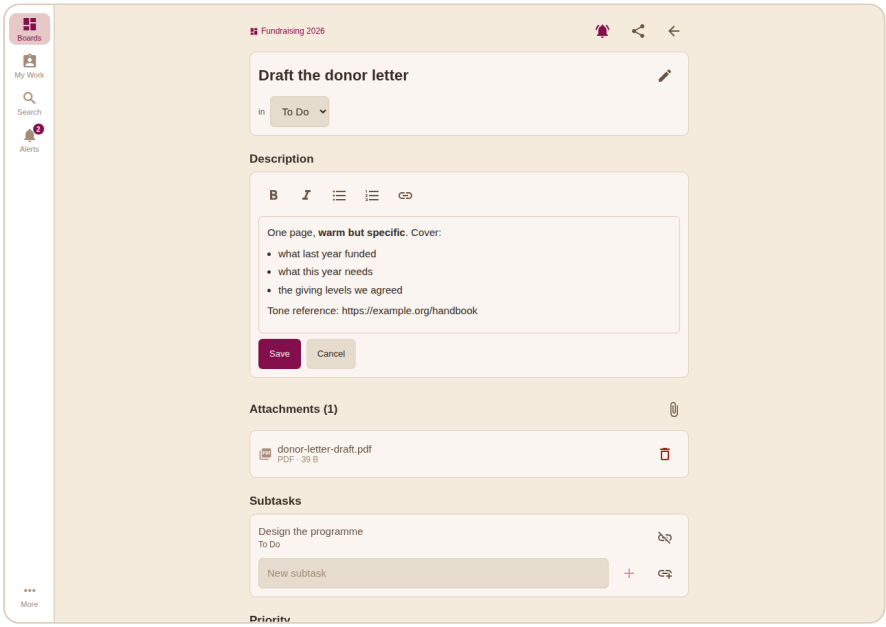
Ordinary actions — move, archive, assign, delete — are **icons**, not big buttons, so a card stays compact. Each icon has a label for screen readers.

The back arrow is the same everywhere. Any screen you opened from another one has a ← in its top right; it never appears as the word "Back".

The formatting buttons



On a phone



In a browser

The same five buttons sit above the description and above the comment box, on a phone and on a computer alike. A button takes on a **soft coloured background** while the cursor sits in text it already applies to, so you can tell bold from not-bold without selecting anything first. They are icons, like the rest of the app; each one is labelled for screen readers.

You are editing the finished text, not writing codes: what you see in the box is what everyone else sees on the card.

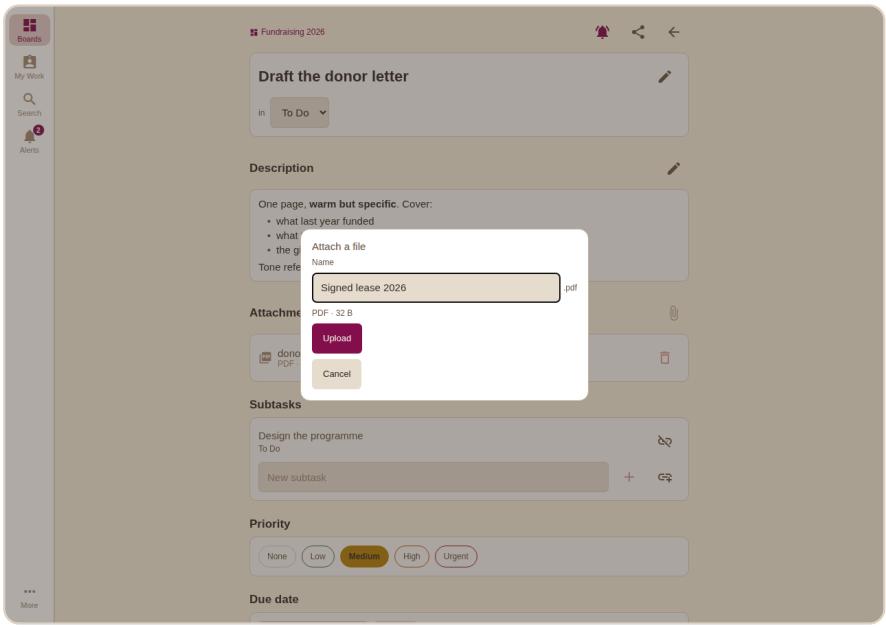
Attachments — putting files on a card

Tap the **paperclip** beside the *Attachments* heading.

On a computer that opens your file browser. **On a phone** you're asked where from: **Choose a file**, **Photo library**, or **Take a photo** — so a receipt or a whiteboard can go straight onto the card without saving it anywhere first.



On a phone



Naming a file before it uploads

Then you get to name it. Before the upload starts, a box shows the file's name, size and kind. Change the name if you want to — `IMG_20260815_113244` means nothing to anyone next week, `Signed lease` does — and press **Upload**. Leave it alone and press Upload to keep the name it came with.

The **extension** (`.pdf` , `.png`) sits beside the box and isn't editable, and that's deliberate: it's how your phone or computer knows what to open the file with. A file with no extension — and a name that merely happens to contain a dot, like `Notes on v1.2 planning` — is yours to edit all the way through. If the file is over 10 MB the box says so and won't let you upload it, rather than letting you wait and then failing.

You can only name a file at this point — **not afterwards**. If you get it wrong, remove the file and attach it again.

- **Up to 10 MB per file**, any type, as many as you like on one card.
- Each file shows its **name, kind and size**. Tap it to **open it** — a PDF in your PDF reader, a photo in your gallery, everything else in whatever app you normally use for it.
- The **bin icon** removes a file. **Anyone on the board can remove any file**, not just whoever added it — attaching the wrong thing is an easy mistake and shouldn't need chasing someone else. It asks first, and it cannot be undone.
- Attaching and removing both appear in **Activity**, with who did it.

While a file is uploading you'll see a progress bar. If it doesn't finish — you lost signal, or closed the app — the file simply isn't added; nothing half-made is left on the card.

Files live with the card. Move the card to another board and they go too; archiving a card keeps them. Deleting a card permanently deletes its files.

Finding an archived card

Archiving takes a card off the board but **keeps it**. Tap the **archive icon** — in the row along the bottom on a phone, in the header in a browser — to see everything archived on that board, **most recently archived first**. Each card carries two icons: **restore** puts it back on the board, and the red **bin** deletes it permanently. Anyone who can archive can restore; permanent deletion stays with the board's owners and admins, and it **asks first** because nothing brings a deleted card back.

If the column a card came from has since been deleted, it comes back in the **first column** and says so — rather than refusing to come back at all.

Subtasks — breaking a card down

A card can be broken into **subtasks**, which are simply other cards on the same board, linked to it.

- Type a title under **Subtasks** and tap **+** to create one. It’s made in the same column as the card you’re on.
- The **link icon** beside it attaches a card that’s already on the board. There’s a filter box, because a board can hold a lot of cards.
- Tap any subtask to **jump straight to it**; it opens like any other card, with its own column, assignees, due date and comments. The subtask shows **Subtask of** at the top — tap that to come back up.
- The unlink icon separates the two cards again. **It does not delete anything** — the subtask stays on the board as an ordinary card.
- A parent card shows a small **N subtasks** marker on the board, so you can tell at a glance that it breaks down further.

A subtask is a real card, not a checklist item: it moves through columns, gets assigned, and can be discussed like anything else. A card can be a subtask of only one other card, and both must be on the same board.

Sharing a card

The top of every card shows **which board it’s on** — tap it to jump straight to that board. Beside the back arrow is a **Share** button. It hands the card’s link to your phone’s share sheet — WhatsApp, Google Chat, a text, whatever you use — or, on a computer, copies the link to paste anywhere.

Whoever opens the link lands directly on that card, as long as they’re signed in and a member of its board. If they aren’t a member, or the card has been deleted, the link says so instead of opening a blank screen.

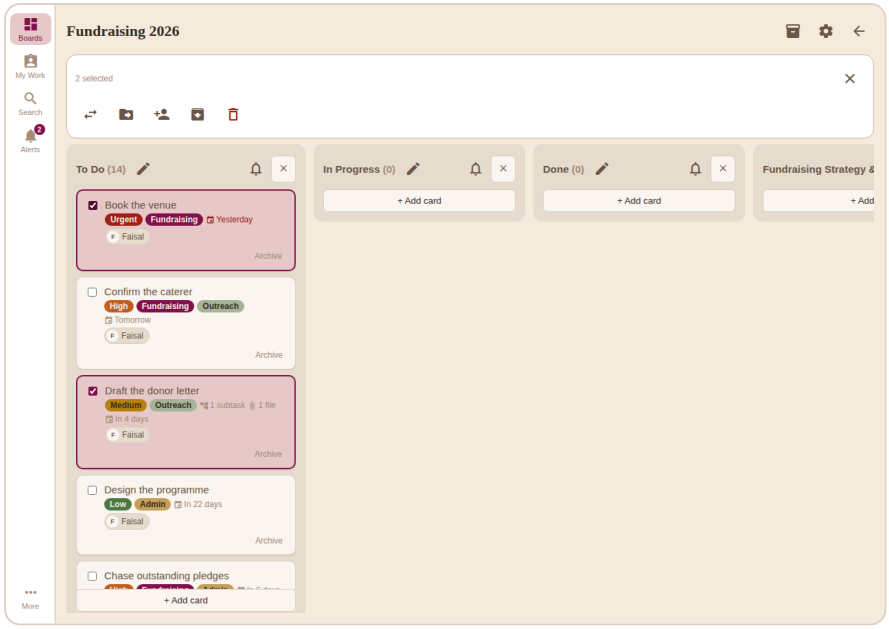
Moving cards

In a browser, drag a card between columns. **On a phone**, long-press the card and pick the destination column — dragging isn’t used on a screen that already swipes between columns, where a drag would be ambiguous.

1.6 Doing several cards at once



On a phone — long-press, then tap



In a browser — tick the boxes

Select several cards — **tick the boxes** in a browser (hold **Shift** for a range), or **long-press** one on a phone and then tap the rest. A bar appears with what you can do to the whole selection: **move**, **assign**, **archive**, or (owners of the board) **delete**. It shows how many are selected, and the ✕ beside that count leaves selection mode without doing anything.

You can also **copy or move the selection to another board** — pick one of your boards, then a column in it.

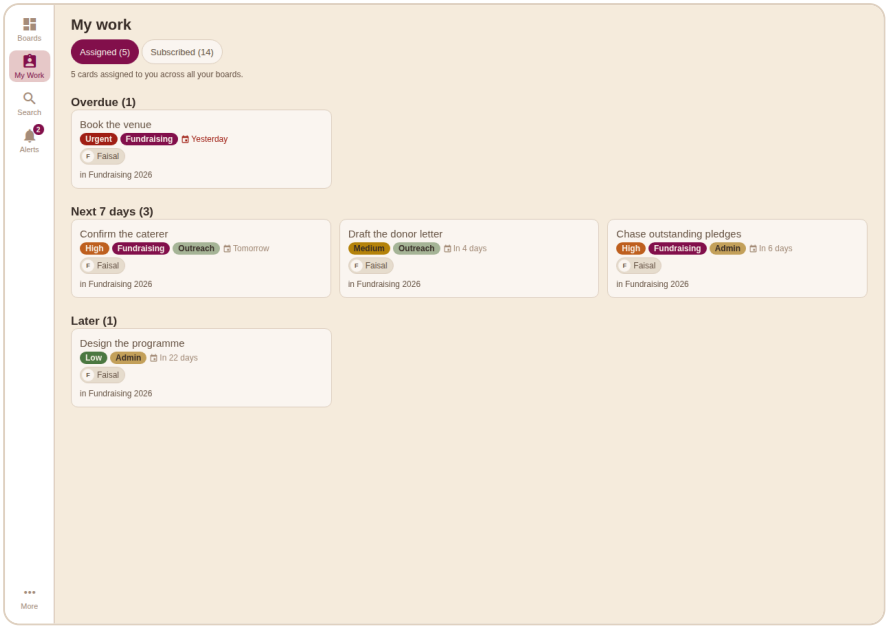
- A **move** takes each card over exactly as it is: comments, history and attached files all travel with it, because it stays the same card.
- A **copy** leaves the originals alone and starts **fresh** cards — same title, description, priority, due date and labels, but **no comments, no history and no files**. A copy is new work, not a second pointer at the same work.

Labels come with both, since they are shared by every board and mean the same thing wherever a card lands. Anyone **not a member of the destination board is unassigned**, though; the sheet tells you before you confirm.

1.7 My Work



On a phone



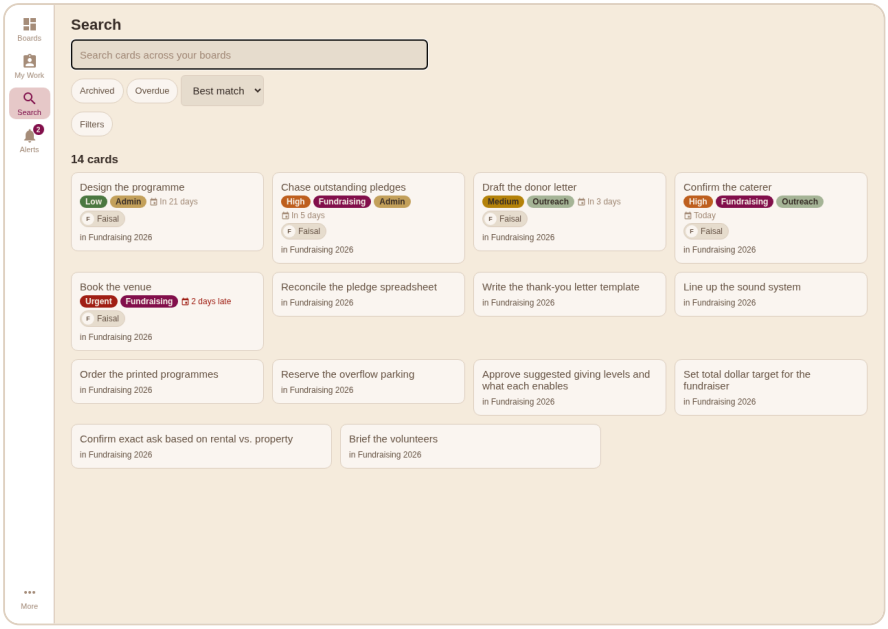
In a browser

Everything assigned to you, across every board, grouped by urgency: **overdue** first, then **today**, then the **next seven days**, then everything else. This is the fastest way to see what needs you — especially on a phone. Tap any card to open it.

1.8 Search



On a phone

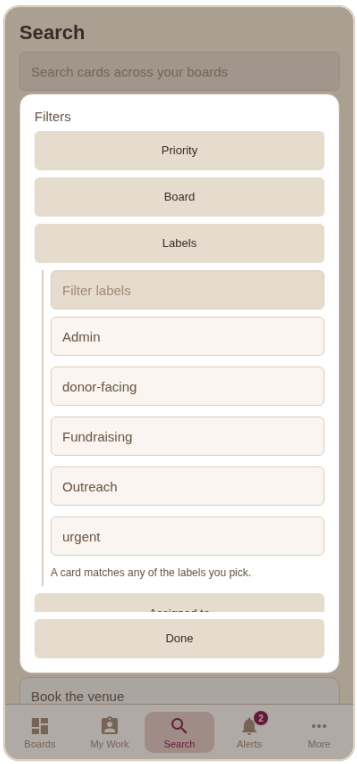


In a browser

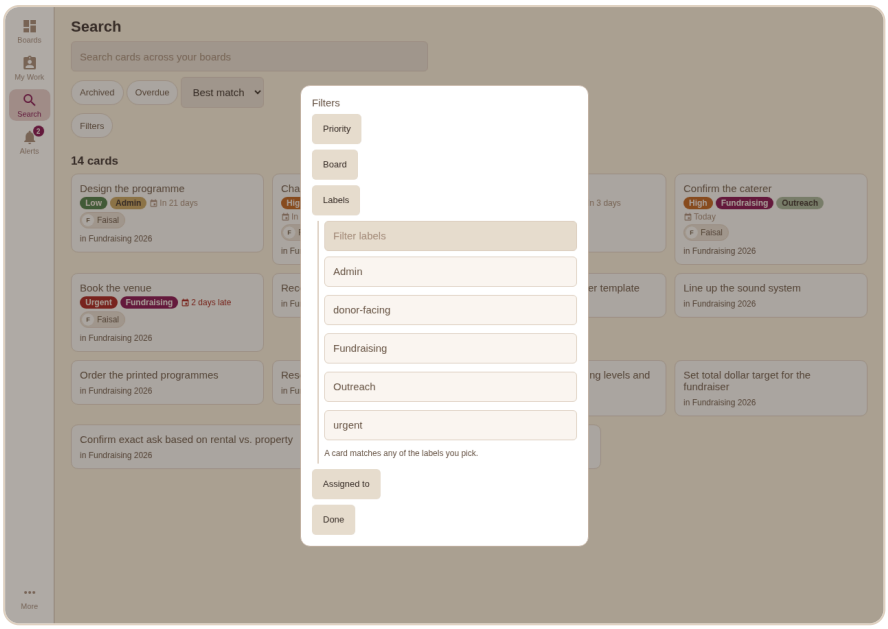
Search lists **every card on every board you're on**, newest first — you don't have to type anything, and **the keyboard stays shut** until you tap the box, so you can browse and filter without it covering half the results. Typing narrows by title and description; it matches whole words and parts of words, but not misspellings.

Above the results are **filter chips**. The first row is one tap each, plus the sort control:

- **Archived** — shows **only** archived cards, and hides the live ones. This is the other way to find something you archived, alongside a board's own archive.
- **Overdue** — only cards past their due date.
- **Sort** — see below.



On a phone



The Filters panel

The second row starts with **Filters**, which opens a panel holding everything that is a *list of choices* rather than a switch. The sections start closed; tap one to open it, and it closes whatever was open before — so the panel stays readable on a phone. Each heading tells you what it is doing without being opened (`Board: Fundraising 2026`, `Labels (2)`):

- **Priority** — pick any number of them: **Urgent**, **High**, **Medium**, **Low** and **None**. Picking two gives you cards at either. **None** means cards with no priority set — it is a choice, not “no filter”.
- **Board** — narrow to a single board.
- **Labels** — pick one or several; you get cards carrying **any** of them.
- **Assigned to** — narrow to one person’s cards, or back to **Anyone**.

Board, Labels and Assigned to each have a **box to type in** at the top, which narrows the list as you type — quicker than scrolling once there are a lot of boards or people.

Picks take effect straight away and the panel **stays open**, so you can set several without reopening it. **Done** closes it.

Whatever you pick comes back as **its own chip** in that second row, so the answer to “what am I filtering by?” is always one row you can read at a glance — and tapping a chip removes that filter, the same gesture as everything else. When anything is active, a **clear-filters** icon appears at

the end of the row and switches every filter off at once. It is only there when there is something to clear, and the panel carries a **Clear all** button that does the same, because the panel covers the icon while it is open. Your **Sort** is not a filter and neither control touches it — the order you chose stays where you put it.

Sorting

The **Sort** control has three settings:

- **Best match** (the default) — with something typed, the closest matches come first; with the box empty, the most recently active cards do.
- **Newest first** — most recently active at the top, whatever you've typed.
- **Oldest first** — the reverse, which is how you find the things nobody has touched in months.

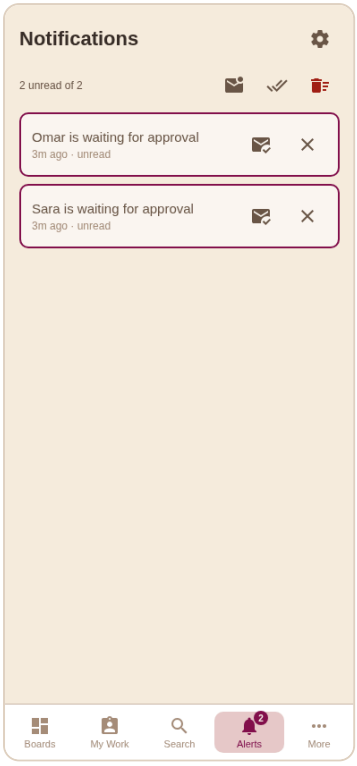
"Active" means someone **edited the card, commented on it, or attached or removed a file**. Just opening a card doesn't count, and neither does subscribing to it.

Your search survives leaving it. Open a result, then come back, and the text, the chips and the board and label picks are all as you left them — you don't have to rebuild a search to look at a second card. Filters reset when the app is reloaded, because a filter you set last week isn't one you meant to still be looking through today.

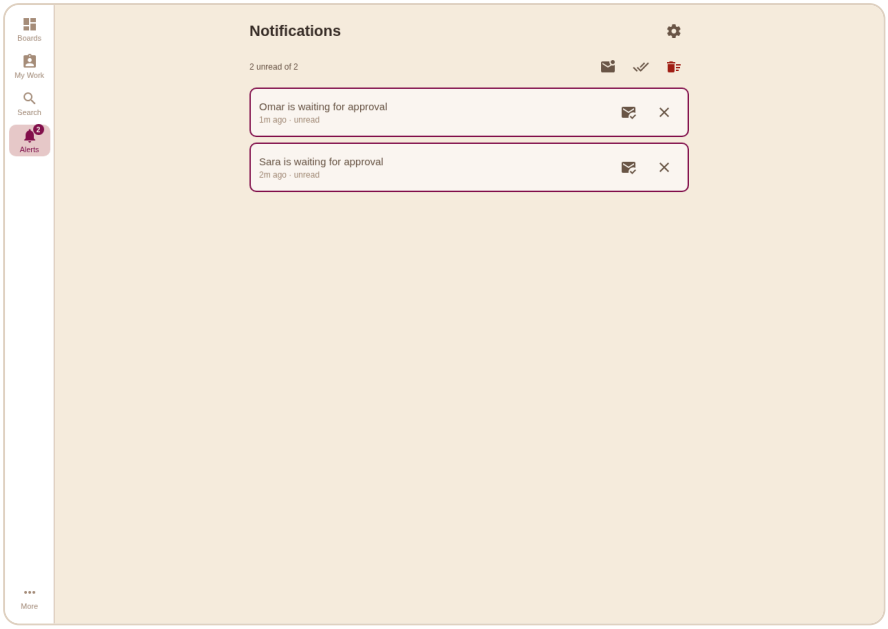
Search looks at the WORDS you see, not at the formatting, so searching for `bold text` finds a card that shows **bold** text. One honest limit: it searches the words of a link, not the address behind it.

If there are more results than fit on screen the app says so, rather than quietly cutting the list short. Tap a result to open the card.

1.9 Notifications



On a phone



In a browser

Alerts shows everything you've been told about, so nothing is lost if a phone notification is missed or swiped away. You're alerted when a card is **assigned** to you, when someone **@mentions** you in a comment, when there's a new comment or a change on a card you **follow** (one you're assigned to or subscribed to), when a card arrives in a column you **watch**, and — for admins — when a **new account** is waiting. If several arrive at once, your phone shows one notification and Alerts has each of them. Unread items are outlined; tap one to go straight to what it is about — the card for a card alert, **People** for an account waiting for approval. A notification shows whether the app is open, in the background or closed — on a phone and in a browser alike. Tapping it on your phone's lock screen or in its notification tray, or on your computer's notification, does the same thing as tapping the item in Alerts, including when the app was not running: in a browser it opens in the tab you already have open, or in a new one.

Each item has two icons: an **envelope** and a ✕. The envelope flips between read and unread — on an unread item it marks it read, and on one you have already read it puts it **back to unread**, so you can leave something flagged to come back to. Nothing is sent to anybody when you do that: marking an alert unread does **not** produce another phone notification, and never notifies the person whose action it was about. The ✕ dismisses the item for good.

Tapping the item itself opens what it is about and marks it read — so if you flagged something unread and then look at it, it goes back to read.

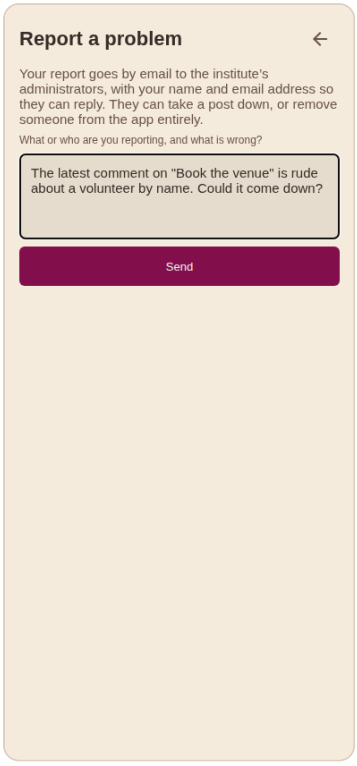
At the top of the list, the **envelope** shows **only what is unread** (tap it again to see everything), ✓✓ marks everything read, and the **sweep** icon empties the inbox — that last one asks first, because dismissed alerts cannot be brought back.

Alerts keeps the last **90 days** and clears out anything older on its own, so the list stays worth reading. Nothing is lost by it — a card keeps its own comments and activity permanently.

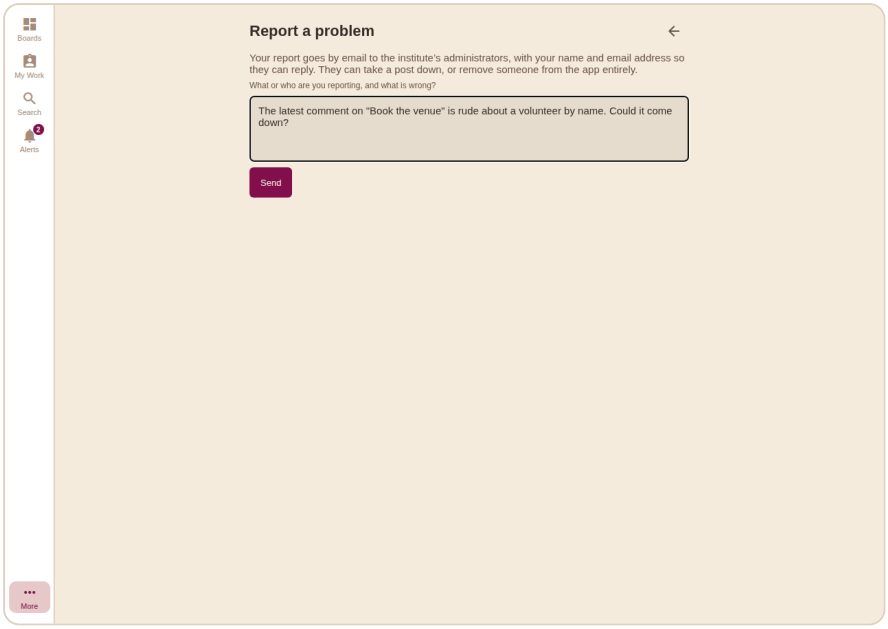
The **gear** opens notification settings, where each kind of notification has an on/off switch and you can **mute** individual boards with the bell. **You are never notified about your own actions.**

Push notifications need the device's own permission. The app offers to set it up once, on the Boards screen after you sign in — or you can open the **gear** here any time and use **Enable notifications**. It is once per device, and this screen always says where this device stands — including after you change the setting outside the app and come back to it. If notifications have been blocked, the button becomes **Open settings** on a phone; in a browser, allow them from the site settings behind the icon in the address bar. Notifications follow the account signed in on the device.

1.10 Reporting a problem



On a phone



In a browser

If something on a board breaks the institute's rules — a card, a comment, a file, or the way someone is behaving — tell the administrators: **More → Report a problem**.

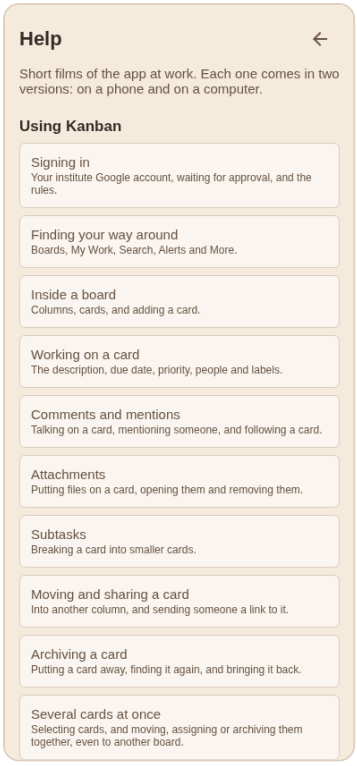
There is one box: **What or who are you reporting, and what is wrong?** Say which board and card, or which person, and what the problem is, in your own words. Then **Send**.

- **"Sent. An administrator will reply by email within a day."** The report has gone to the institute's administrators by email, with your name and email address so they can answer you. They act on it within 24 hours: they can take a post down, or remove someone from the app entirely.
- **"Your report was saved but the email did not go out; it will be looked at."** The report is kept, and the administrators will still see it; there is no need to send it again.

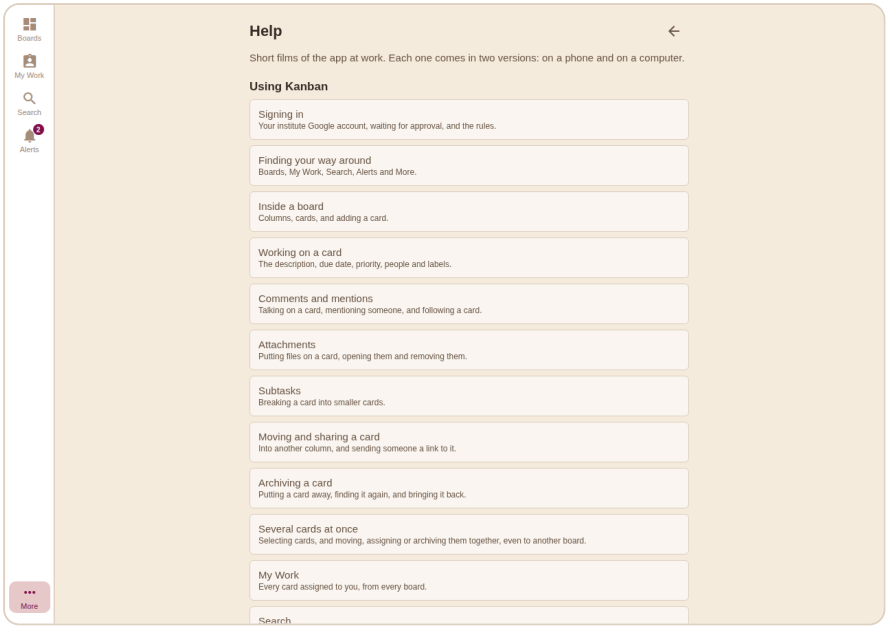
Leave the screen before sending and your words are still there when you come back. You can send up to five reports an hour. Nobody but the administrators sees a report.

There is no way to block one colleague: blocking is all or nothing. If someone should be stopped, report them, and an administrator can remove them from the app. If @mentions are what bothers you, you can turn mention notifications off altogether in **Alerts → Settings**.

1.11 Help — short films



On a phone



In a browser

More → Help lists short narrated films of the app at work, one for each thing people do in it: signing in, a board, a card, comments, attachments, search, alerts and the rest, then running a board, then the admins' screens. Everyone sees every film, so a member can see what an owner or an admin does and knows whom to ask.

Each film comes in two versions, **on a phone** and **on a computer**, because the two layouts differ. A film opens on the version for the screen you're watching on; the two icons above it switch to the other. In a browser a film has captions; in the phone app, tap the film for its controls and full screen.

The films show a made-up institute, not your boards, and they play over the internet, so on a slow connection give one a moment to start.

1.12 Signing out

More → Sign out (in the navigation bar). Signing out clears your session on this phone or browser and stops it receiving that account's notifications. The next sign-in shows Google's account chooser, which is how you switch accounts.

Part 2 — For board owners

Two separate things decide what you can do, and it is worth being clear about which is which.

Your role — set by an admin under **People** — says what you can do across the whole organisation. There are three:

- **Member** — the boards you've been added to, and nothing else.
- **Organizer** — the same, plus **creating new boards**. That is the whole of the difference.
- **Admin** — everything, including every board. See Part 3.

Owning a board is separate, and belongs to the board rather than to you. Whoever creates a board owns it, and an owner can make any other member an owner too. Owning a board says nothing about any other board: a plain member can own one, an organizer can own none.

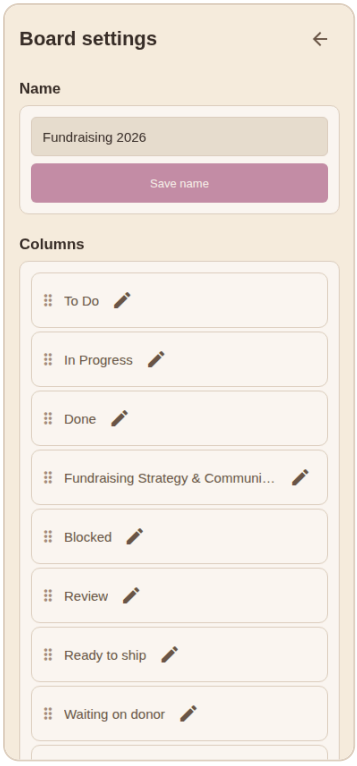
An owner runs the board: its name, its columns, who is on it, who else owns it, archiving it, permanently deleting its cards, and removing anybody's comment.

Everyone else on the board opens the same screen and sees **the member list, read-only, with owners marked** — so you can always see who to ask.

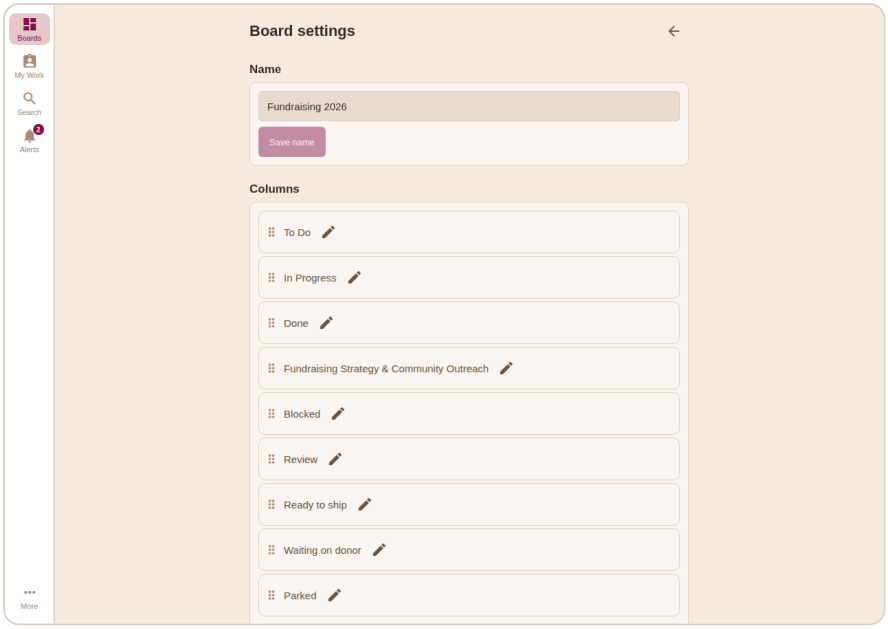
2.1 Creating a board

Organizers and admins. On **Boards**, tap **New board** and give it a name. Every new board starts with three columns — **To Do**, **In Progress**, **Done** — which you can rename or replace in Settings. **You own the board you create**, and only an admin can change that.

2.2 Board settings

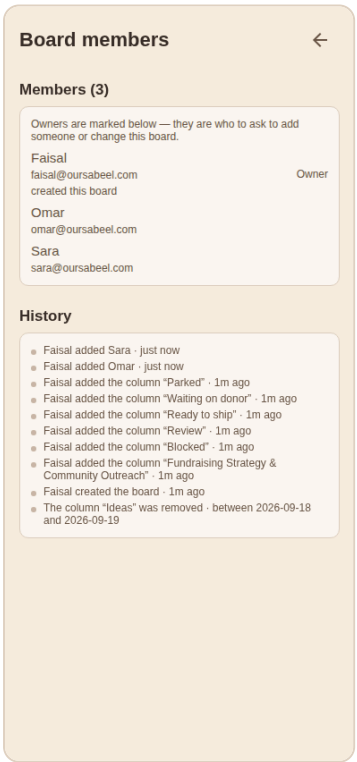


On a phone

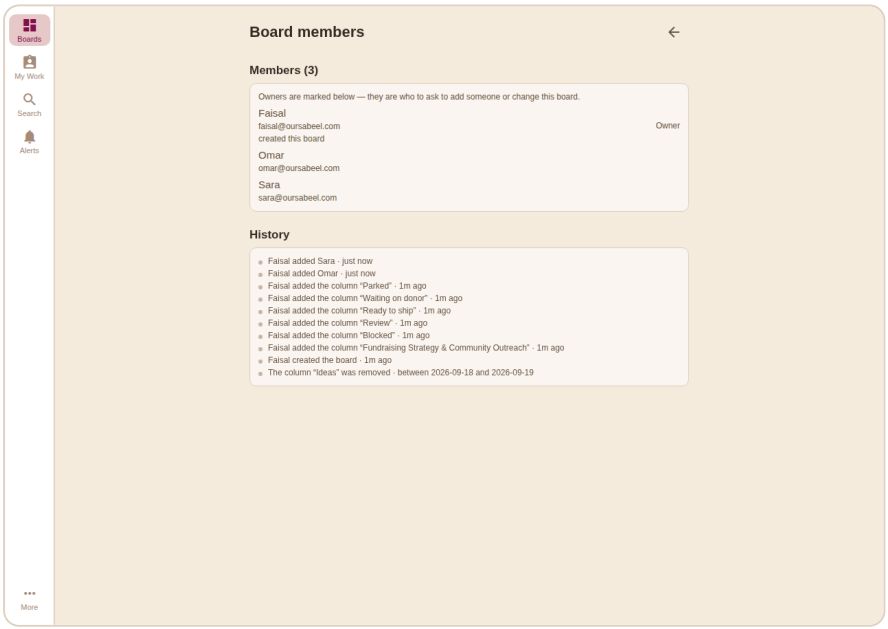


In a browser

Open a board and tap its **settings** (the gear — along the bottom on a phone, in the header in a browser). If you don't own the board the icon is a **group of people** instead and says **Board members**: the same screen with the member list and the board's history, and nothing else.



The same on a phone



Not an owner, in a browser — owners marked, no controls

From here:

- **Name** — rename the board. This screen is the only place that does it, which is why a member who cannot open it cannot rename a board either.
- **Columns** — add, rename, and reorder. Tap the **pencil** beside a column's name to rename it; drag the handle to reorder. A column can only be deleted once it's **empty**, so no cards vanish with it, and deleting one **asks first** because it cannot be undone. To clear a column quickly, select its cards and move or archive them in one go.
- **Labels** — one vocabulary shared by **every board**, not just this one, so anything you do to a label here changes it everywhere. The panel says so.

Anyone can add one: open any card and press **+** beside its labels, and it joins the shared set and lands on that card at the same time. **Only an admin renames, recolours or deletes one** — a label is shared, so changing it reaches cards on boards you may not even be able to open, and that is an organisation- wide decision rather than a board one. If you own a board but are not an admin you will see the labels listed with no controls beside them.

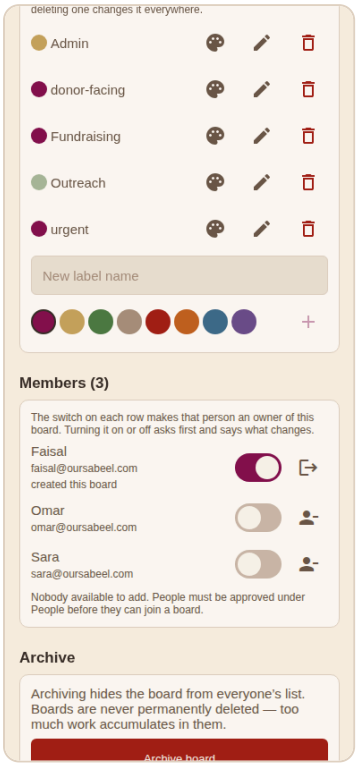
Admins get a **pencil** to rename, a **palette** to cycle the colour and a **bin** to delete. Deleting asks first and tells you how many cards carry it, because it comes off all of them.

Colours come from a fixed palette so they stay readable on the app's warm surfaces. Names are short by design, and two labels can't share a name even in different capitals — a card face shows the name and nothing else, so "Urgent" and "urgent" would be impossible to tell apart. - **Members** — who can see the board. Tap the **add-person** icon beside the *Members* heading to see who else can be added, and tap a name to add them. Removing someone (the **remove-person** icon on their row) also **unassigns them from that board's cards** — you're told how many before it happens — and takes away their ownership of it if they had any. **Adding them back later does not give the ownership back**; turn the switch on again if you mean to. Your **own** row shows a **leave** icon instead — use it to step off a board you no longer work. Members who don't own the board ask an owner to take them off it.

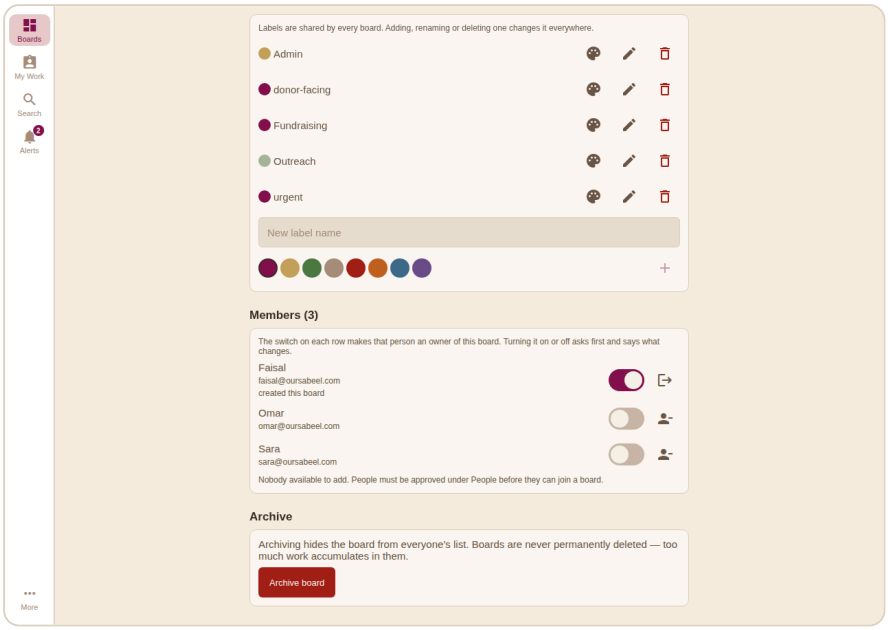
Somebody removed while they have the board open is told they no longer have access to it, rather than being left looking at a screen that will not load. - **Owners** — each member's row carries a switch that makes that person an owner. A line at the top of *Members* says so, and both directions

ask before anything happens. See below. - **Archive** — hides the board from everyone's list. Boards are never deleted outright. - **History** — what has happened to the board itself, newest first. See below.

Letting somebody else run the board



On a phone



In a browser — the Owner switch sits on each member's row

Turn a member's switch on and they can run the board exactly as you can; turn it off and they go back to being an ordinary member, keeping the board and everything on it. **Both directions ask first** and spell out what changes, so a stray tap grants nothing. The line above the list says what the switch is for; the confirmation says what it will do.

Unless you created the board, you can step down the same way — your own switch works like anyone else's. The confirmation is worth reading: **you cannot undo it.** You stay on the board and keep using it, but another owner or an admin has to give ownership back. Step down as the last owner and only an admin can change the board at all.

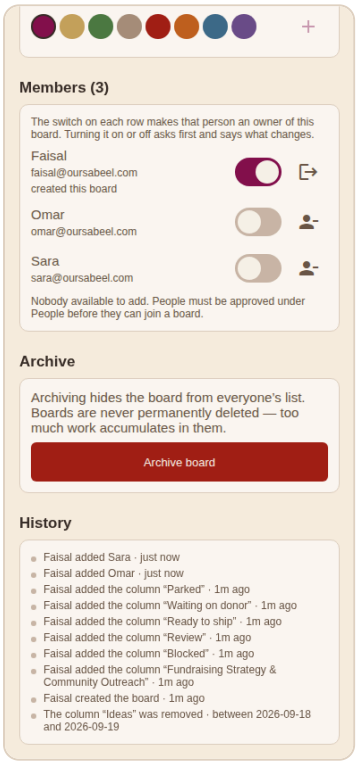
The person who **created** the board is marked *created this board*, and their switch is locked: **only an admin** can take ownership away from them — even when it is you and you want to hand the board on. Ask an admin.

A board can end up with **nobody** owning it — its creator left it, or an admin took the last owner off. Nothing is lost, but only an admin can change that board until somebody is made an owner again.

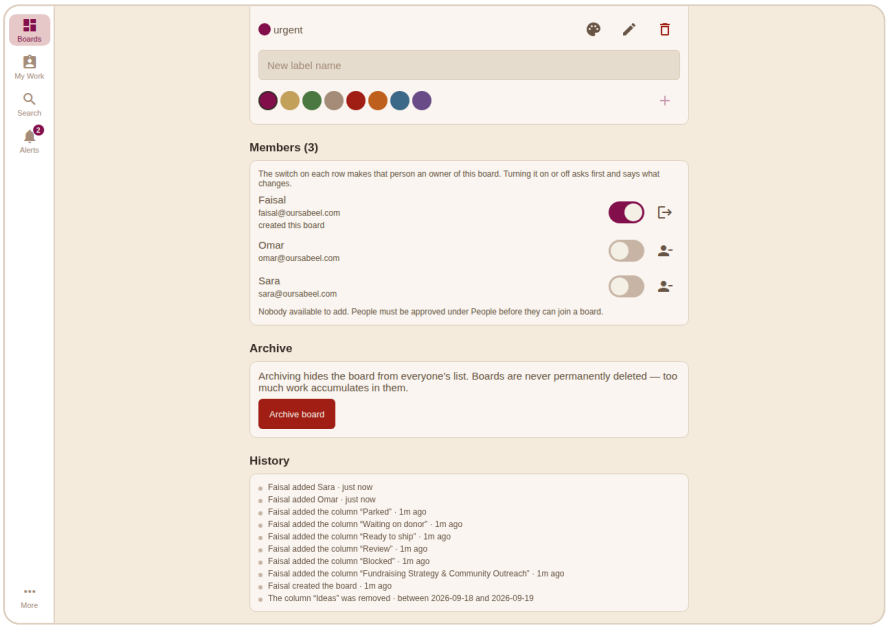
Renaming a column without opening Settings. Column names are editable from the board itself too — tap the **pencil** beside the column name (on a phone, in the column header at the top; on a wide screen, at the top of each column). Only the board's owners and admins see it; everyone else just sees the name.

Joining or leaving a board yourself. Neither is self-service for an ordinary member: an owner of the board adds you, and an owner takes you off. **Leave** is on your own row in *Members* if you own the board. (Admins are the exception, since they can open any board's settings; a board they haven't joined shows a **Join this board** button at the top of *Members*.)

The board's history



On a phone



In a browser

At the bottom of the screen, **History** lists what has happened to the board itself, newest first, and who did it: who created it, renamed it, archived or restored it; who added or removed whom; who made someone an owner or stopped being one; which columns were added, removed, renamed or reordered. Everyone on the board sees it, owners or not. What happens to a card is in that card's own history, on the card.

Nobody can edit or delete a line of it. The newest twenty show first; **Show older** brings in the next twenty.

Some lines name nobody — *The board was archived* rather than *Sara archived the board*. Those changes were made before the app recorded who made them, and pieced together afterwards from the institute's daily backups; a time such as *between 2026-08-12 and 2026-08-13* means the change happened somewhere in that span. A change made from an out-of-date copy of the app also names nobody, so keep the app up to date.

2.3 Archiving a board

Boards **archive**, they don't get hard-deleted, so nothing is lost by accident. An **Archived** section sits at the bottom of your board list, holding the archived boards you belong to — open one from there and use **Restore** in its settings to bring it back. It stays collapsed unless something is actually archived, and only an owner of that board (or an admin) can restore it.

Archiving a board **puts its work away too**: its cards drop out of everyone's **My Work** and **Search**, and it stops sending notifications and due-date reminders. Nothing is deleted — restore the board and all of it comes straight back, exactly as it was.

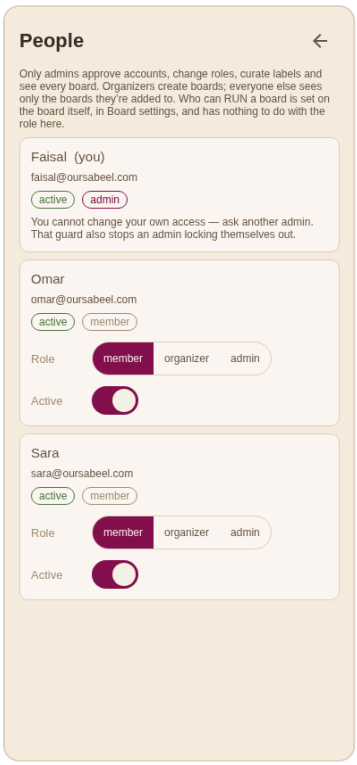
2.4 Deleting cards

Anyone on the board archives cards; **its owners and admins can delete** them permanently. Archiving keeps a card out of the way but recoverable; deletion is final and takes its comments and history with it. When in doubt, archive.

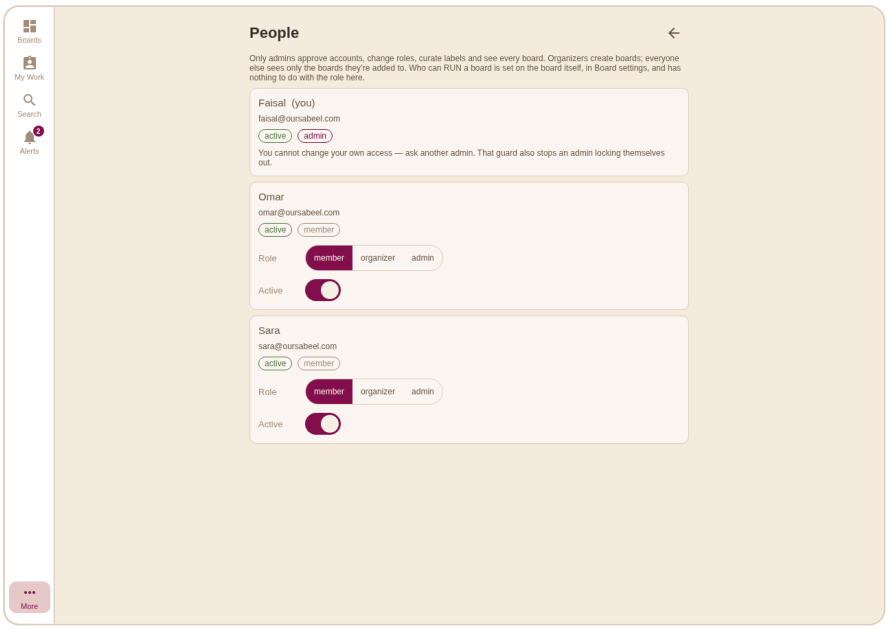
Part 3 — For admins

Admins manage **people**, curate the shared **labels**, and read **Stats**. They can also open, run and join **every** board, whether or not they were added to it — the one exception to boards being private.

3.1 The People screen — approving new users



On a phone



In a browser

Open **More → People**. It lists everyone who has signed in. A new account waits on **pending** and sees nothing until you approve it — approve it here and their screen unlocks live, wherever they are. Admins also get a push notification when someone is waiting.

3.2 Managing a user

Each person's role and access are shown as **controls set to their current value** — a **role** (member / organizer / admin) and an **Active** toggle — rather than buttons you press. You change someone by moving the control to where you want it:

- **Member** — sees only the boards they've been added to.

- **Organizer** — the same, plus **creating boards**. That is the only difference. They own the boards they create, and nothing on anyone else's.
- **Admin** — everything: every board, the shared labels, Stats, and approving accounts and changing roles.
- **Active** — turn off to **disable** an account. Whatever they have open switches to an "Account disabled" screen straight away, wherever they are, and they cannot sign back in. **Their card assignments are kept** so nothing is left ownerless — an owner of that board can reassign at leisure. Turn back on to restore. Nothing is ever deleted.

If they are the **only owner of a board**, the confirmation names it. Disabling still goes ahead — losing access is usually the urgent half — but that board then needs a new owner, which you can give it from its settings.

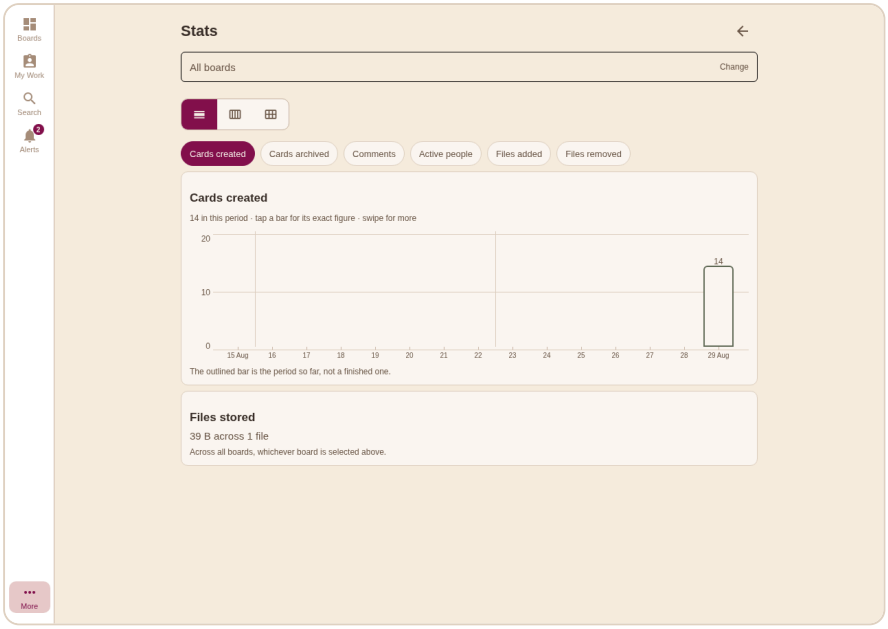
Every change asks you to **confirm**, spelling out what it will actually let that person do, so a stray tap can't promote or lock out anyone. You **cannot change your own access** — that's what stops an admin locking themselves out.

Who runs a board is NOT set here. It is set on the board, under *Board settings → Members*, and is independent of the role above. An admin can open any board and give anybody ownership of it.

3.3 Stats — how the boards are being used



On a phone



In a browser

More → Stats. Admins only. It answers “is this being used, and by whom?” — nothing about individual performance, and nothing you can drill into a person with.

Three controls sit above the chart:

- **The board** — one board, or **All boards**. Archived boards stay in the list and are marked, because archiving a board doesn’t retract the work that happened on it.
- **Daily / Weekly / Monthly** — the three calendar icons. Weeks run **Sunday to Saturday** and months are real calendar months, not rolling windows, so a week here is the week everyone means.
- **What to measure** — cards created, cards archived, comments, **active people**, files added, files removed.

Active people counts how many *different* people did something that day — not who signed in. Opening the app changes nothing; creating a card, commenting or attaching a file does.

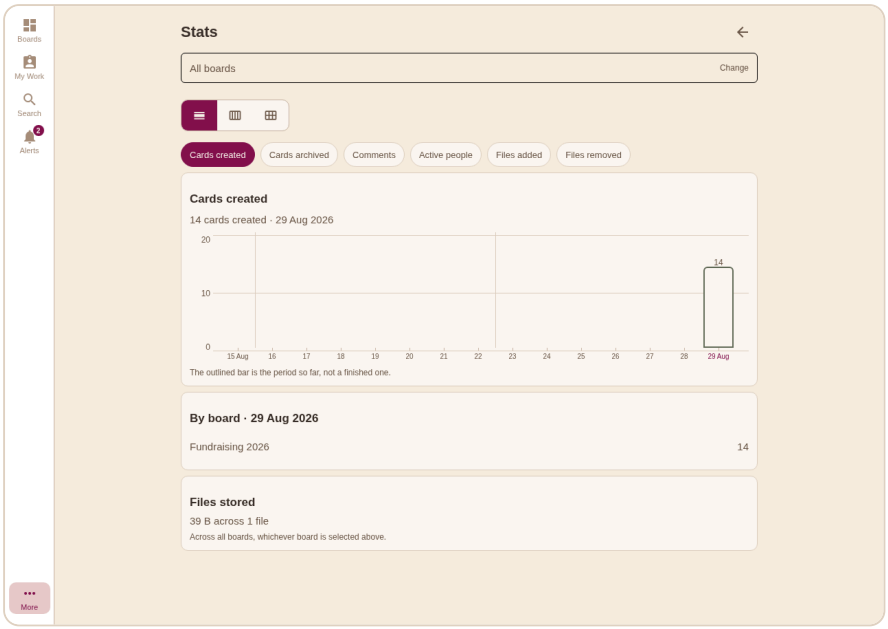
The chart scrolls sideways when there are more bars than fit; **tap a bar** for its exact figure and date. The **last bar is outlined rather than filled** because today isn’t finished yet — a half-day next to whole ones would read as a decline that hasn’t happened. Below it, **Files stored** gives the

total size held across all attachments.

Tap a bar to see what is behind it



On a phone



In a browser

Selecting a bar adds a panel underneath it, and what the panel shows depends on what you are measuring:

- **Active people** lists **who** — the actual people who did something in that day, week or month.
- **Everything else** lists **which boards**, largest first. **Tap a board to go straight to it.**

Tap the same bar again to put the panel away. There is no panel until you select something, on purpose: without a bar chosen it would have to cover the whole year, which is a different question.

Come back from a board and Stats is exactly as you left it — same board filter, same period, same measure, same bar selected.

History goes back **twelve months** and is kept indefinitely. Figures for past days are counted once and stored, so the screen opens instantly however much history there is; only the current day is worked out live.

Part 4 — “How do I…?” quick answers

…see how something is done? More → Help, and pick the film. Each one comes as it looks on a phone and on a computer.

…get in for the first time? Sign in with your @oursabeel.com Google account, then wait on the approval screen until an admin lets you in (it updates by itself).

…add a card? Open the board → **+ Add card** at the foot of a column → type a title → Enter.

…change a card’s priority, due date, or assignees? Open the card → tap a priority / due date / **Assign someone** → choose.

…move a card to another column? In a browser, drag it. On a phone, long-press it and pick the column — or open the card and change the **column** dropdown.

…move or copy cards to a *different board*? Select them (tick boxes, or long-press on a phone) → **move/copy to another board** → pick the board and column.

…find a card I can’t see? Search (its words), or **My Work** if it’s assigned to you.

…share a card with a colleague? Open the card → **Share** → send the link. They open it and land on the card (if they’re a member of its board).

…see everything assigned to me? My Work — grouped overdue → today → next seven days.

…report a post or a person? More → Report a problem → say what or who, and what is wrong → **Send**. An administrator replies by email within a day.

…stop a noisy notification? Alerts → Settings → switch off that kind, or **mute** the board.

…keep an alert to deal with later? Alerts → the **envelope** on its row puts it back to unread. Tap the envelope at the top of the list to show only those. Nobody is notified again.

…create a board? *(organizers and admins)* **Boards → New board** → name it. You own the board you create.

…rename a board? *(the board’s owners)* Open the board → **settings** → Name. That screen is the only place that does it.

…rename or add columns? *(the board's owners)* Open the board → **settings** → Columns.

…add a label? *(anyone)* Open any card → **+** beside its labels. Labels are shared by every board, so it appears everywhere at once.

…rename or delete a label? *(admins)* Open any board → **settings** → **Labels**. Deleting removes it from every card that carries it, and tells you how many first — counting live cards and archived ones separately, because a card in the archive is one no board will show you.

…follow a card that isn't mine? Open it → the **bell** in the header. It appears under **My work** → **Subscribed**, and you'll hear about its comments and changes.

…know when a card lands in a column? The **bell** on the column (on a phone, in the row along the bottom) → you're told whenever a card arrives in it.

…find every card with a particular label? Search → **Filters** → **Labels**, and pick one. Pick more than one and you get cards carrying **any** of them. Each pick becomes a chip; tap it to drop it.

…search within one board only? Search → **Filters** → **Board**. It becomes a chip like everything else — tap the chip to go back to searching everywhere.

…find everything urgent *or* high? Search → **Filters** → **Priority**, and tap both. Priority takes as many as you want, unlike the other sections.

…find cards nobody has given a priority? Search → **Filters** → **Priority** → **None.**

…see what someone else is working on? Search → **Filters** → **Assigned to**, and pick them. Type in the box at the top of the list to find them quickly.

…see what's changed lately — or what has gone stale? Search → **Sort** → **Newest first** for the first, **Oldest first** for the second. "Active" counts edits, comments and files.

…give a file a sensible name? Rename it in the box that appears when you pick it, **before** it uploads. You cannot rename it afterwards — remove it and attach it again.

…clear every filter at once? The **clear-filters** icon at the end of the chip row, or **Clear all** inside the Filters panel. It only appears when something is actually filtering, and it leaves your **Sort** alone.

…see how much the boards are being used? *(admins)* **More → Stats** — cards created and archived, comments, how many different people were active, and files, by day, week or month.

…see which boards those numbers came from? *(admins)* **Tap a bar.** The panel underneath lists the boards behind it, largest first, and tapping one opens that board. On **Active people** it lists the people instead.

…add someone to a board? *(the board's owners)* Board **settings → Members** → add them. (They must be an approved account first.)

…let someone else run a board with me? *(the board's owners)* Board **settings → Members** → turn on the switch on their row → confirm.

…find out who runs a board I'm on? *(anyone)* Open the board → **Board members** — or **Board settings**, if you are one of them. Same screen; owners are marked on it either way.

…find out who archived a board, or who added or removed someone? *(anyone on the board)* Open the board's settings (**Board members** if you don't own it) → **History**, at the bottom.

…hand a board on when I created it? *(needs an admin)* Ask an admin. Only they can take ownership off whoever created a board — the creator cannot even do it themselves.

…delete a card? *(the board's owners, and admins)* Open the card → delete. Everyone else **archives** instead.

…let a new team member in? *(admins)* They sign in once with Google → **More → People** → **Approve** their pending card.

…make someone an organizer or admin? *(admins)* **People** → their card → set the **role** → confirm the dialog. This does NOT decide who runs a board — that lives on the board itself.

…disable someone who left? *(admins)* **People** → their card → **Active** off → confirm. Their assignments and history stay.

Troubleshooting

What you see	What it means	What to do
“Waiting for approval” after signing in	Your account awaits admin approval	Ask your admin; the screen unlocks by itself once approved
“Before you continue” after approval	The institute’s rules, which every account accepts once	Read them and tap **I agree**; it does not come back
“Your report was saved but the email did not go out”	Your report is kept, but its email failed	Nothing to do: the administrators will still see it
“You have sent 5 reports in the last hour”	Five reports an hour is the most one account can send	Wait a while; or tell an administrator directly
You can’t sign in at all, or see “Wrong account”	Only @oursabeel.com Google accounts are allowed	Use your work account, not a personal one
“Update needed” when the app opens	This version of the phone app is too old to keep working	Tap **Open Google Play** (or **Open TestFlight** on an iPhone) and install the update; nothing on your boards is lost
“Still setting up your account” on a first sign-in	The server is taking longer than usual to set up a new account	Tap **Try again** in a minute; your account is fine
A card’s due date is red	The card is overdue	Open it and update the date, or get the work done
“This card is unavailable” from a shared link	You’re not a member of its board, or the card was deleted	Ask one of that board’s owners to add you
A column won’t delete	It still has cards in it	Move or archive its cards first, then delete the column
Removing a board member warns about	They’re assigned to cards on that board	Those cards are unassigned automatically; the warning just says

What you see	What it means	What to do
cards		how many
No push notifications arriving	Permission not granted on this device, or that kind is muted	Allow notifications when the app asks, and check **Alerts → Settings**
A red “Live data error” bar	The app couldn’t reach the server	It clears when the connection recovers, and when you leave the screen; if it persists, tell Faisal what the bar says
“You no longer have access to this board”	Somebody removed you from it, or archived it, while you had it open	Go back to your board list. Ask one of that board’s owners if you should still be on it
Text you underlined loses its underline	Cards hold bold, italic, lists and links — underline is not one of them, and a keyboard shortcut can set it even though no button offers it	Use **bold** or *italic* instead
Pasted text lost its headings or colours	Only the five formatting options survive a paste — but every word does	Nothing to do; reformat the parts you want bold or bulleted

Manual source: `docs/USER-MANUAL.md`. Its images live in `docs/manual/img/` and are regenerated from the seeded dev stack by `node scripts/manual-shots.mjs` (every one except `pending.png`, which needs an unapproved account; `rules.png` is taken by withdrawing a seeded account’s acceptance first). The PDF is built from the markdown by `npx sabeel-ci render-manual`. When the app changes, update all three in the same batch — text, images, PDF.